



Realtech: (Re)building Europe's critical industries

REALTECH CONFERENCE

London, 2024

1 The rise of Europe

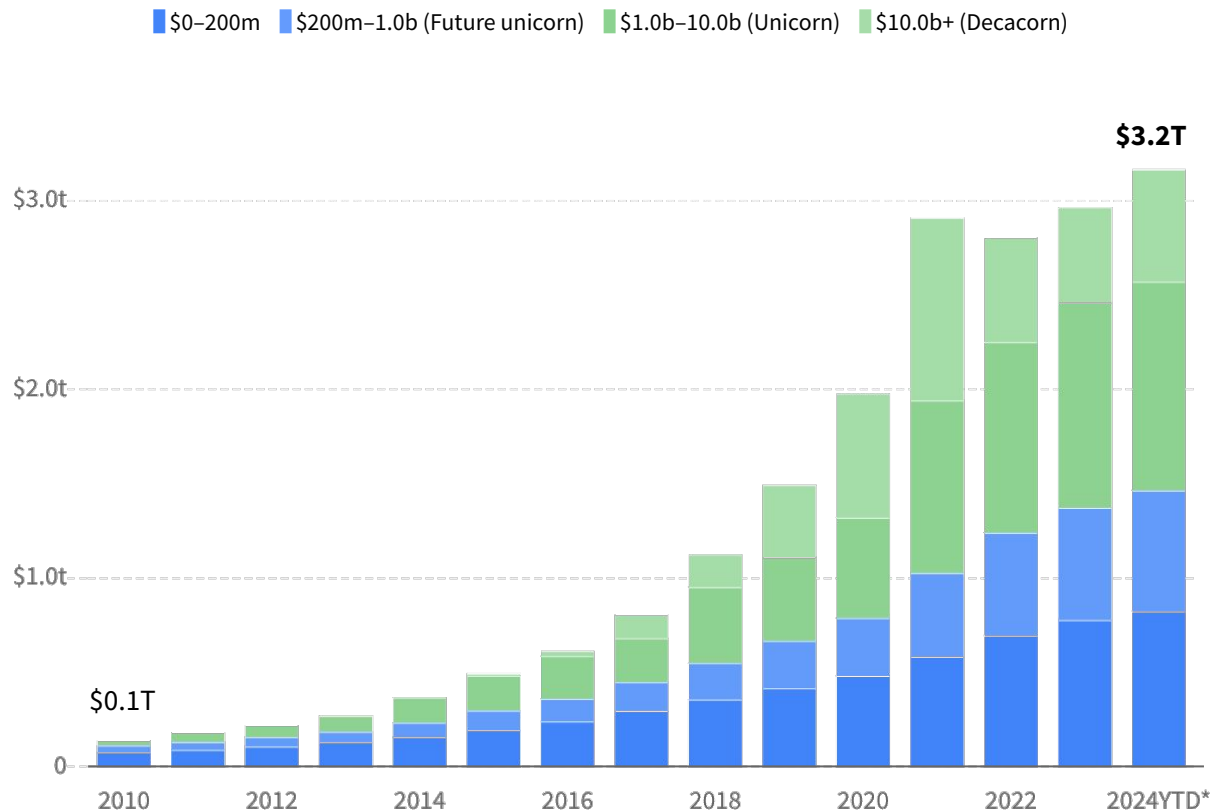
2 Entering the new industrial age

3 Where Europe stands

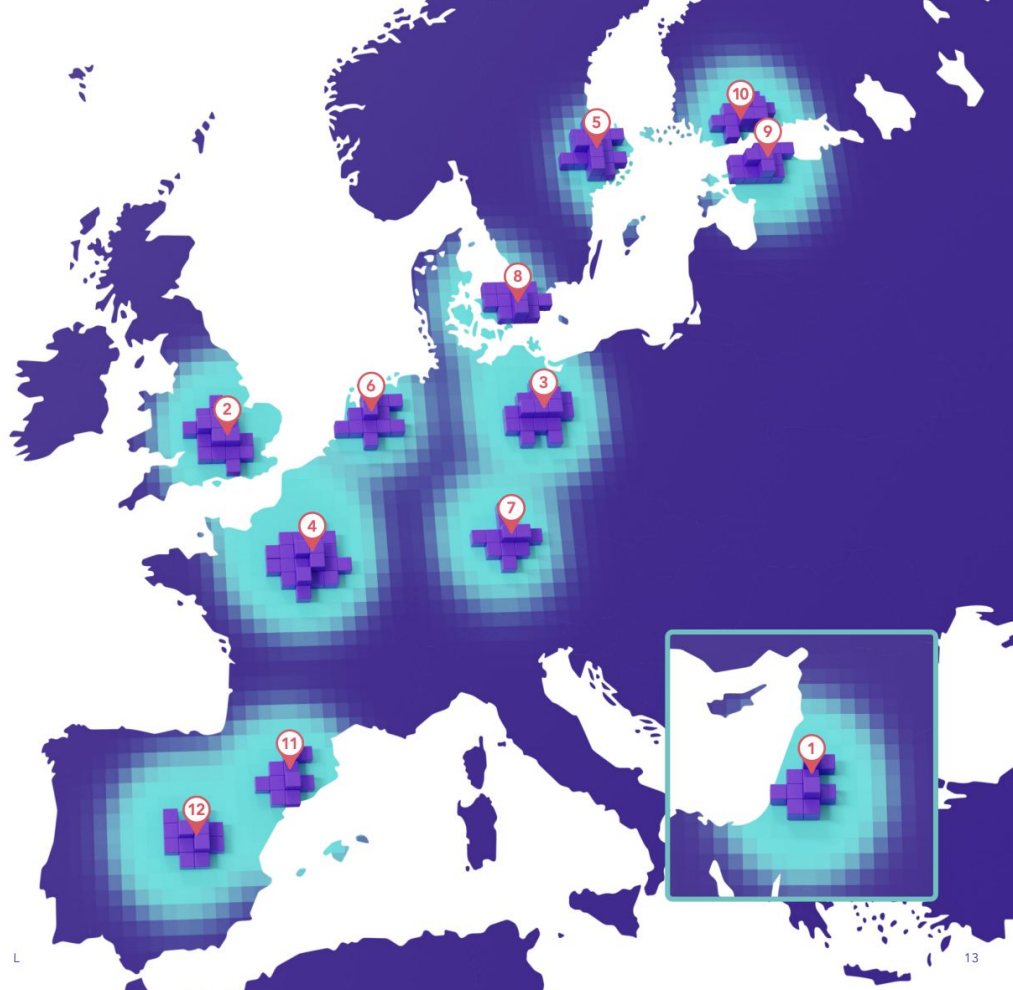
4 Unlocking European Industrial tech

Europe's tech ecosystem is now worth over \$3.2 trillion.

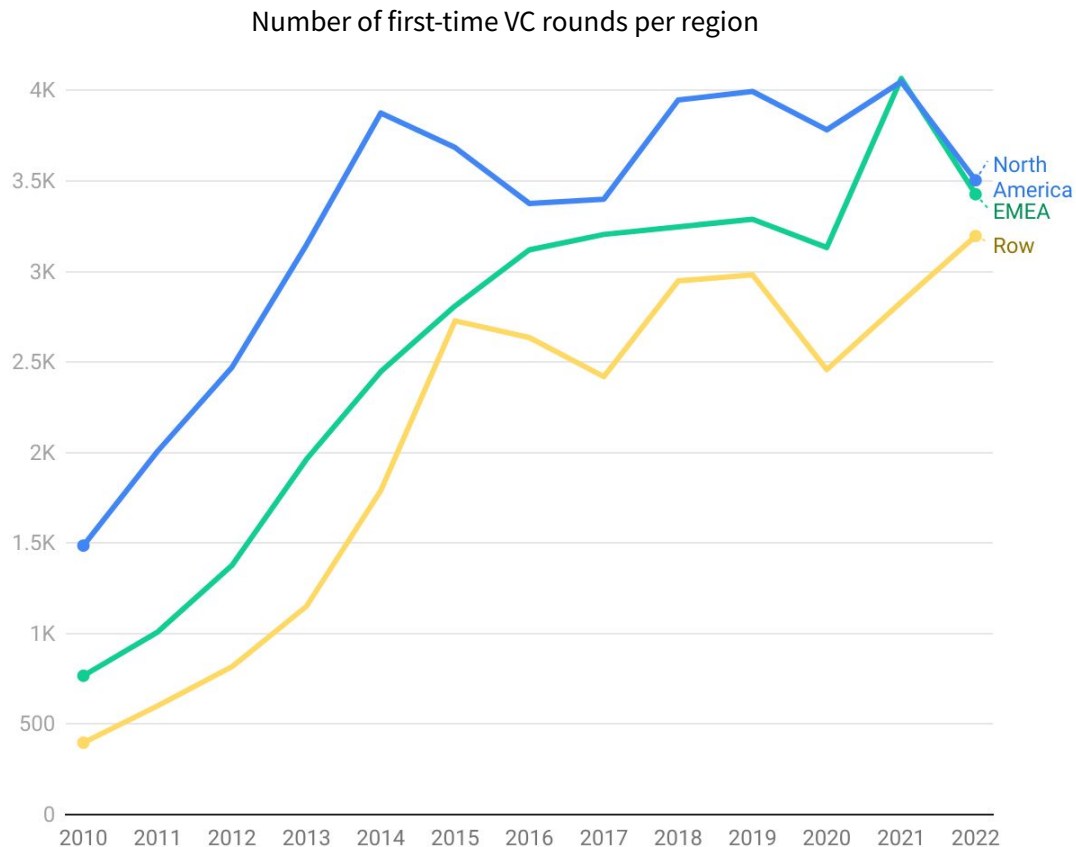
Combined enterprise value of VC-backed European tech companies founded since 1990



More entrepreneurial talent than ever in Europe and Israel.

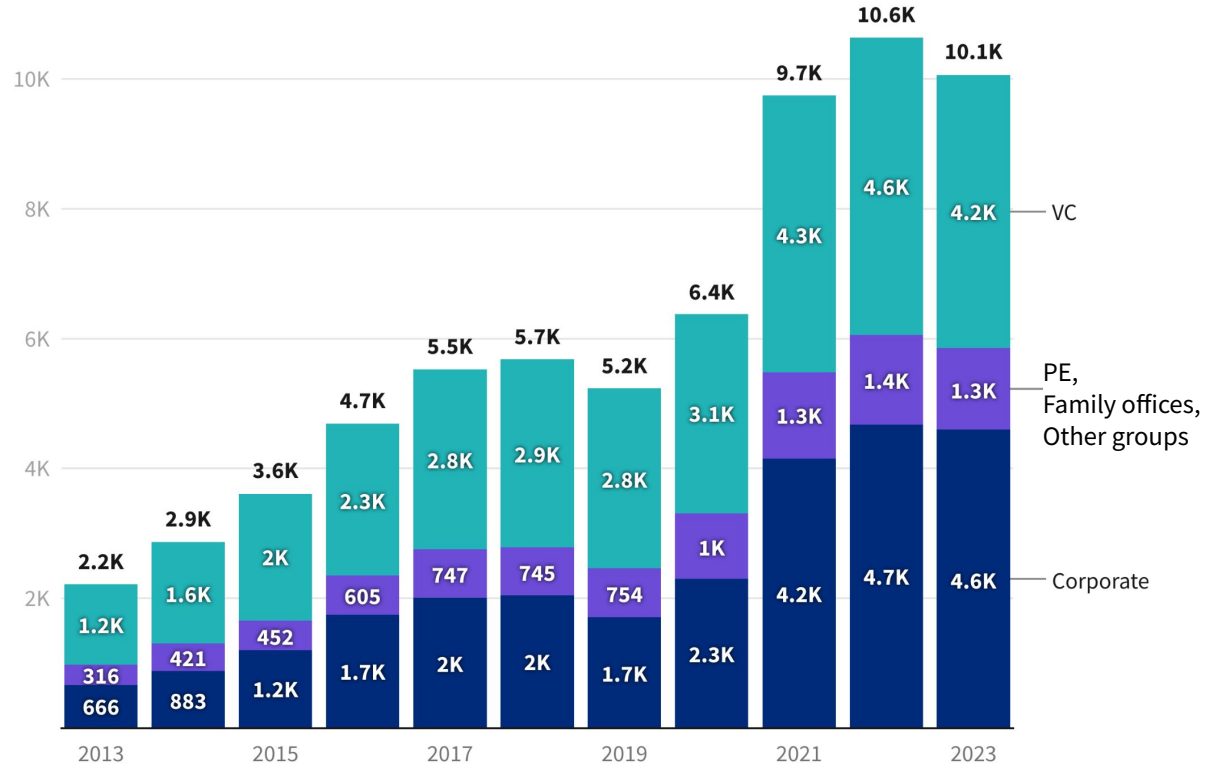


**Every year,
about 3,500 new
startups receive
their first
investment
from a VC
in EMEA.**



Investor interest in Europe has grown more than 4x and has stayed elevated even during 2023.

Unique number of investors in EMEA startups (at least one investment in the year)



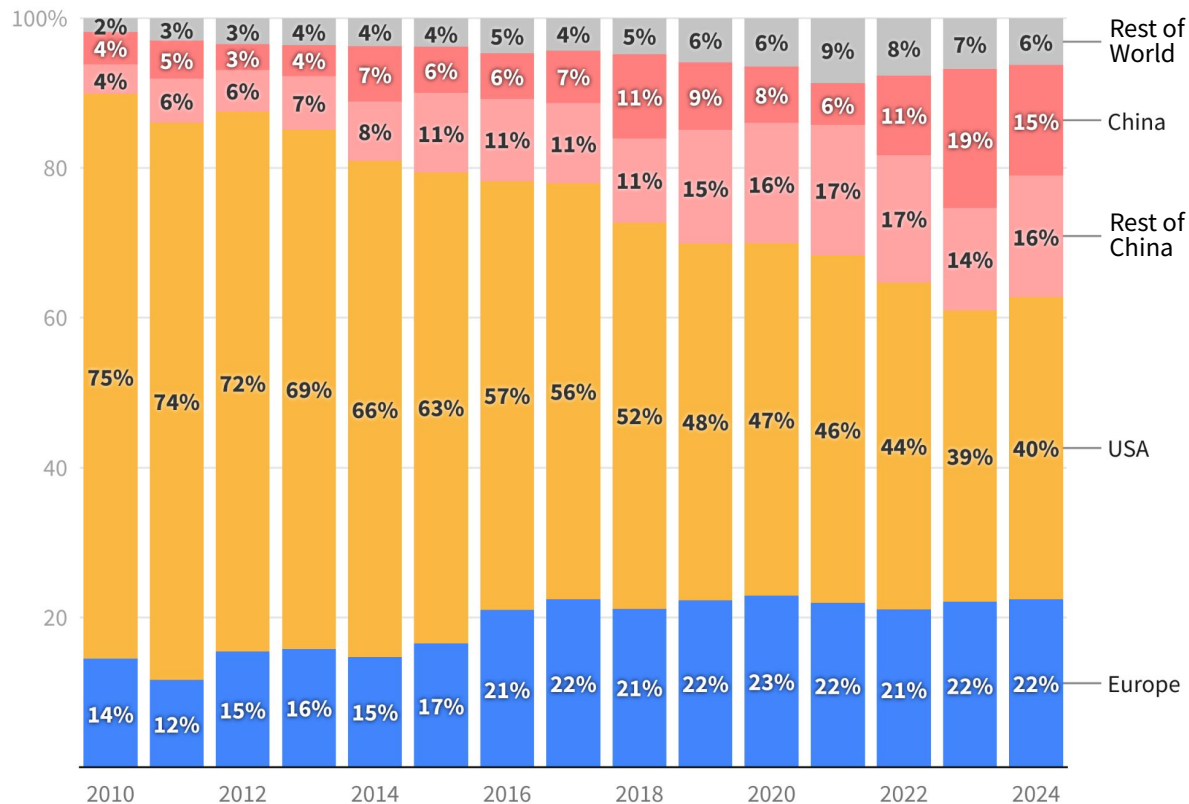
A unique investor is one that did one or more investments.

Europe's share of global early-stage VC is at a record 22% in 2024.

(<\$40M rounds)

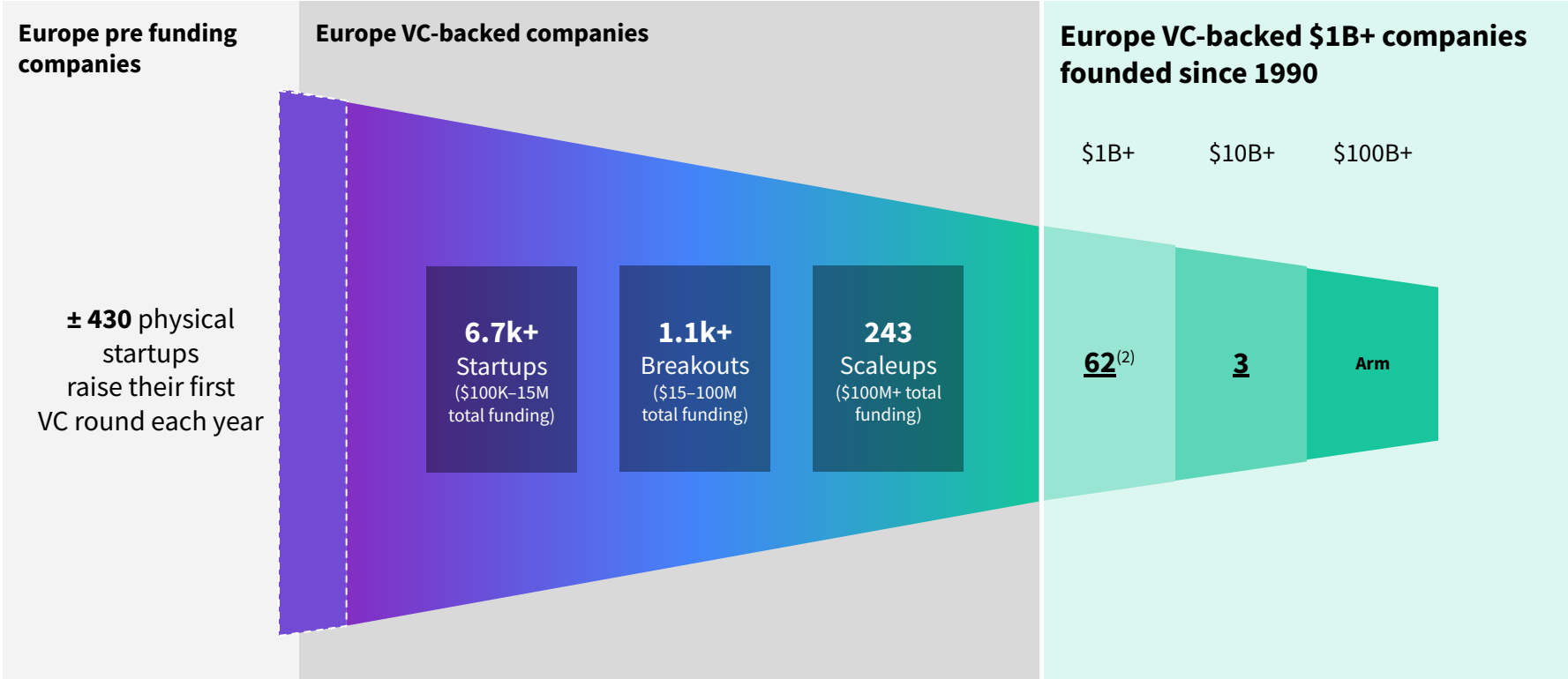
Double the level of 2011.

Distribution of global venture capital, rounds under \$40M

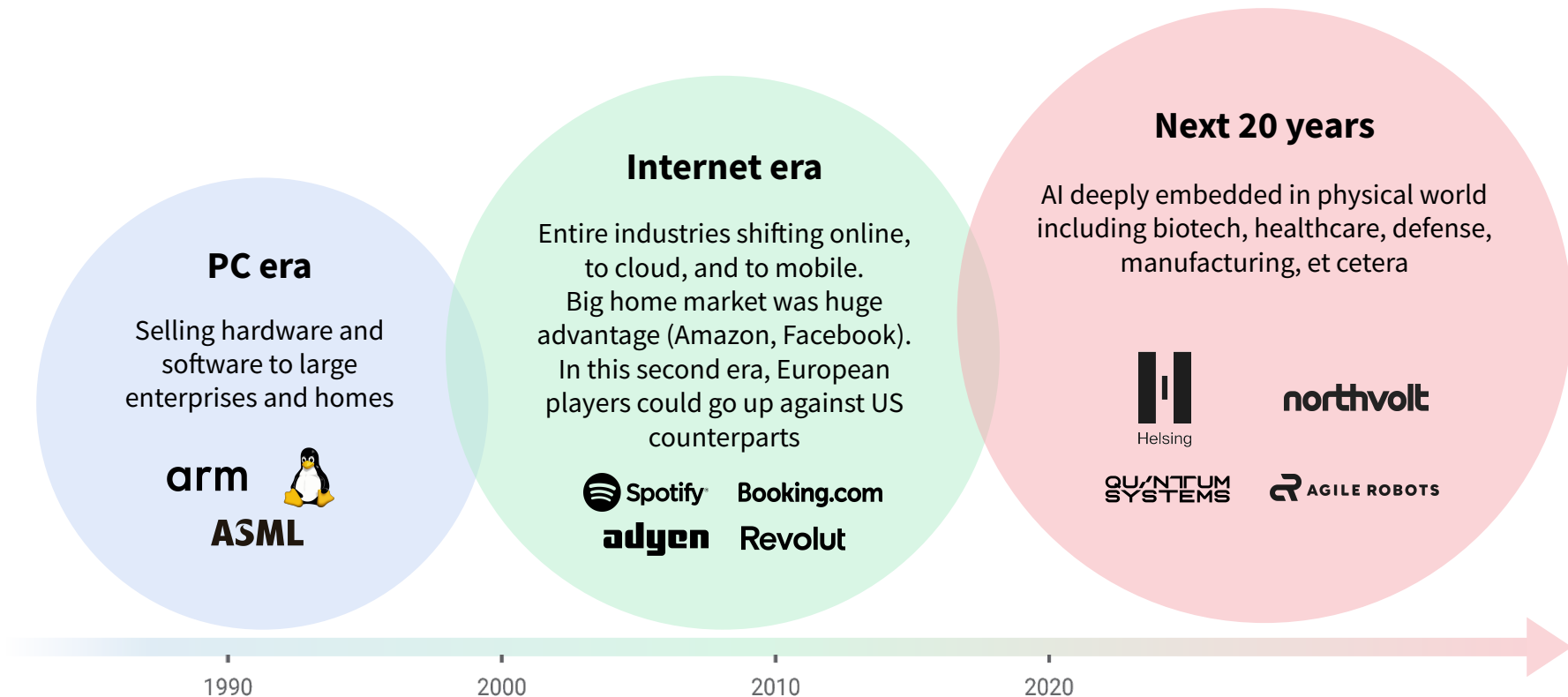


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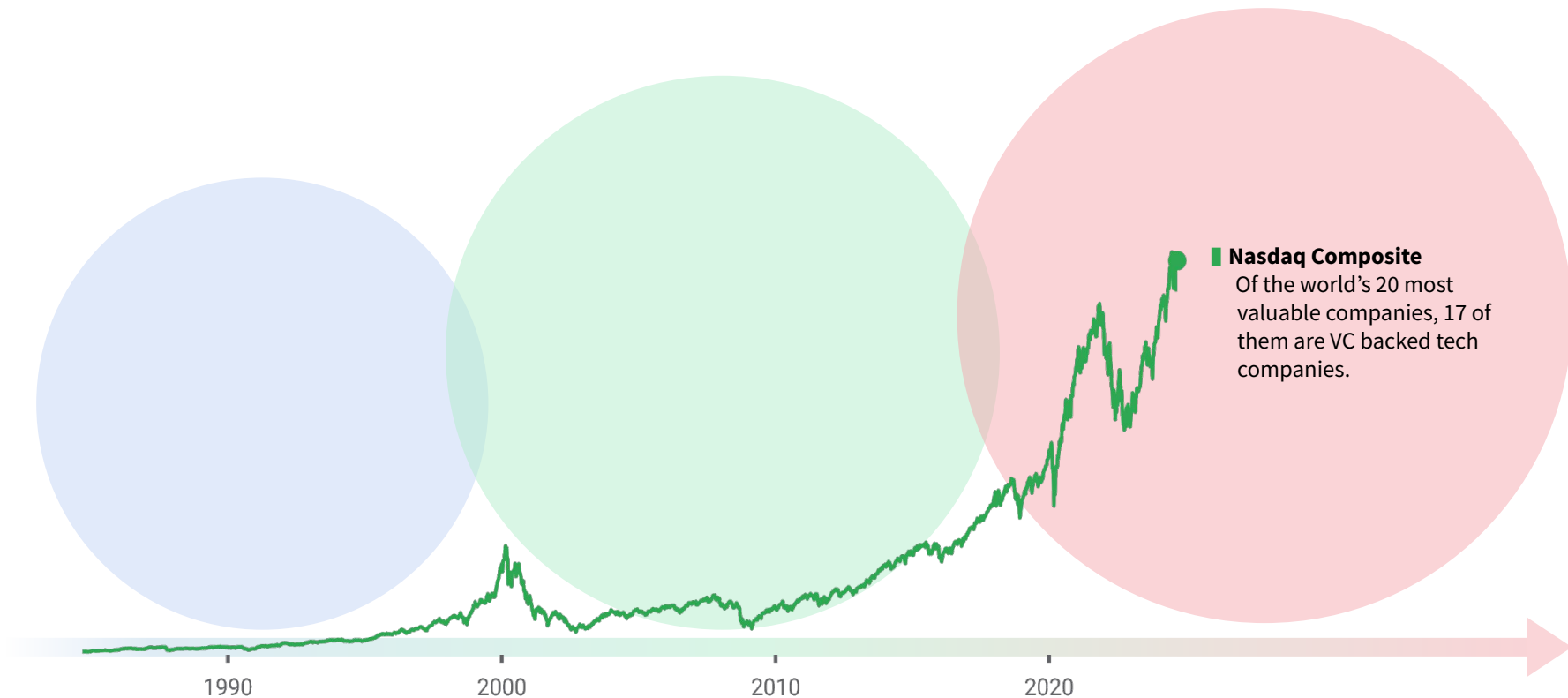
15,000 VC-backed physical industry startups in Europe.



Entering a new era in tech, more driven by Physical Tech.



Each wave of tech has driven more value creation than the last.



35% of the global economy is industrial; an output of \$37 trillion (turnover >\$80 trillion).

Extraction

mining \$5T (4.5%)
+ agri \$4T (4%) =
8.5% of GDP



Industry

manufacturing,
construction, utilities
27% of GDP = \$28 trillion



Enterprise

finance, marketing, legal
consulting, logistics, etc.
32% of GDP = \$33 trillion



Consumer

32% of GDP = \$33 trillion

Why Industrial/Physical Tech matters ...



Climate

driving the
green transition



Geopolitical

ensuring
freedom &
sovereignty



Scarcity

optimizing raw
material use



Skills gap

addressing
workforce
shortages

Why it matters for Europe: a Critical Juncture

Key Challenges

Automotive Industry Decline

Europe's car industry, once dominant, is being outpaced by Tesla and Chinese EV makers, losing market share.

Energy & Material Dependency

High energy costs and reliance on imported fossil fuels & materials are straining competitiveness.

Labor Shortages

An aging workforce and slow digital adoption hinder innovation.

Regulatory Pressure

Digital regulations complicating operations across member states.

Opportunities

Green Transition

Europe can lead in sustainable manufacturing through green tech and renewable energy.

Industry 4.0

Automation and digitalization offer a path to improved efficiency and competitiveness.

Reshoring

Regionalizing supply chains could boost resilience and local economies.

Diverse Sectors

Aerospace and machinery remain strong and ripe for innovation.

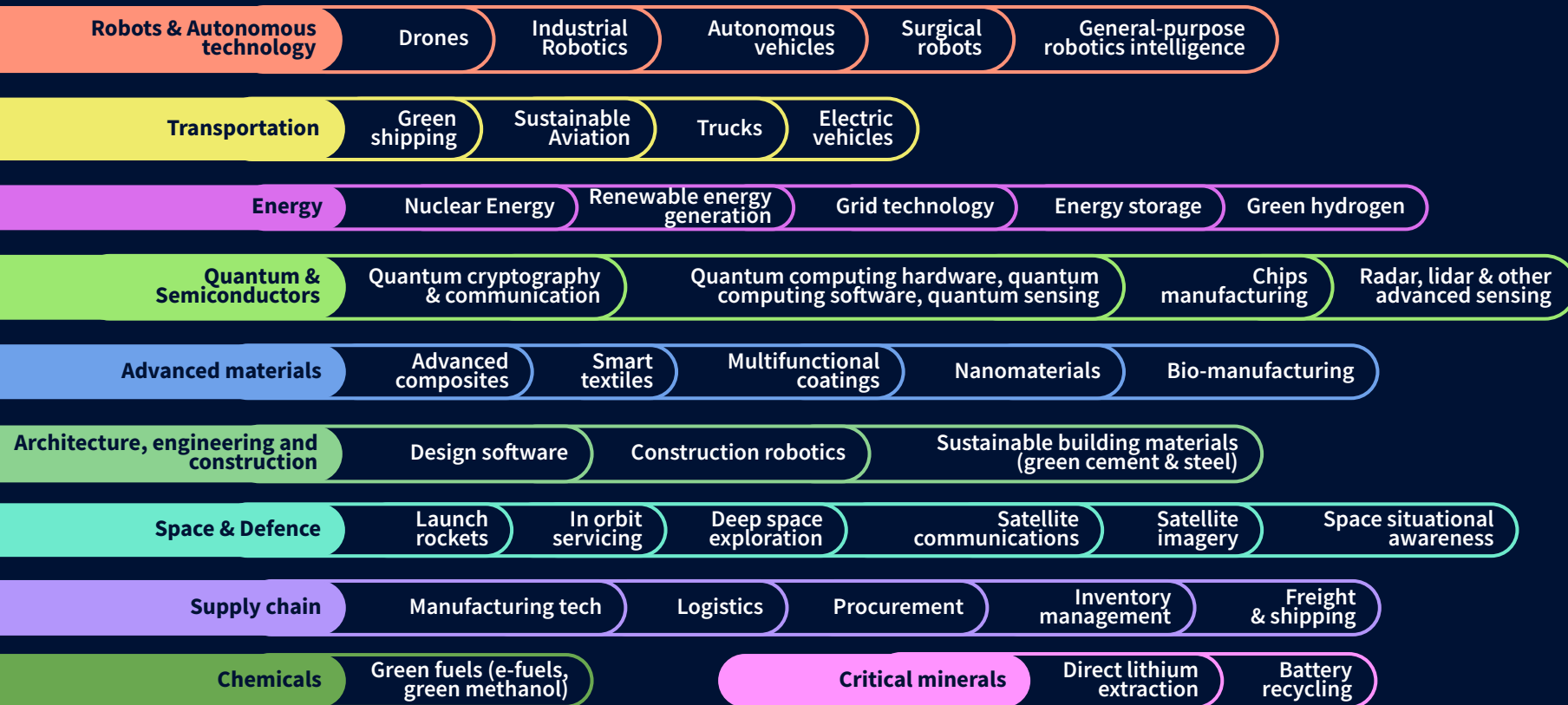
NEWS > FINANCIAL SERVICES

Draghi demands €800B cash boost to stem Europe's rapid decline

“Without action, we will have to either compromise our welfare, our environment or our freedom,” former ECB chief says in hotly anticipated report. Read the full paper here.

Industrial tech / Physical Industries

overview





Cem Uyanik

CEO & Co-Founder at
Urban Ray

URBAN  RAY

“Today's challenges demand real, tangible solutions - physical tech at the intersection of hardware and software. Robotics and automation will reduce the strain on our society and fast-track sustainable progress. Yes, regulations are slow, but in some cases, they are the most modern in the world. Just look at commercial drone applications: flying over densely populated areas is allowed and proven.”

“There has never been a better time to build physical ventures. Europe, with its top-tier talent, forward-thinking regulations, and strong industrial foundation, has everything needed to lead this shift and create a competitive edge over the world. “Made in Europe” is exportable again - we simply need to execute!

“Urban Ray is part of this movement, pushing logistics into a new dimension by making it airborne and automated, driving the future of urban transportation.”

European Upstream Space startups

» Explore the landscape

Materials for space

Combined funding \$ 168M



Semiconductors for space

Combined funding \$ 143M



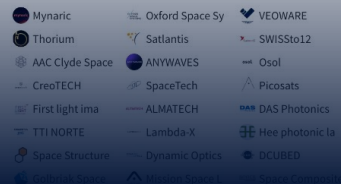
Propulsion systems

Combined funding \$ 44M



Spacecraft parts, structures and payloads

Combined funding \$ 122M



Cybersecurity for space missions

Combined funding \$ 106M



In-space research

Combined funding \$ 6.8M



Mission planning and control

Combined funding \$ 34M



Spacecraft servicing; space debris removal and recycling

Combined funding \$ 35M



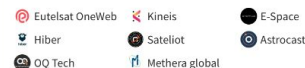
Earth observation satellites

Combined funding \$ 670M



Communication / connectivity satellites

Combined funding \$ 4.7B



Satellite navigation

Combined funding \$ 14M



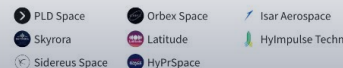
Ground infrastructure

Combined funding \$ 261M



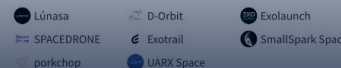
Launch vehicles

Combined funding \$ 807M



In-space transportation spacecraft

Combined funding \$ 202M



Stratospheric balloons and platforms

Combined funding \$ 7.3M



Spaceplanes and hypersonic flight

Combined funding \$ 90M



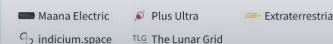
Space resource exploration

Combined funding \$ 132M



Space utilities

Combined funding \$ 50K



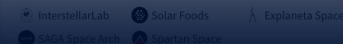
In-space manufacturing

Combined funding \$ 40M



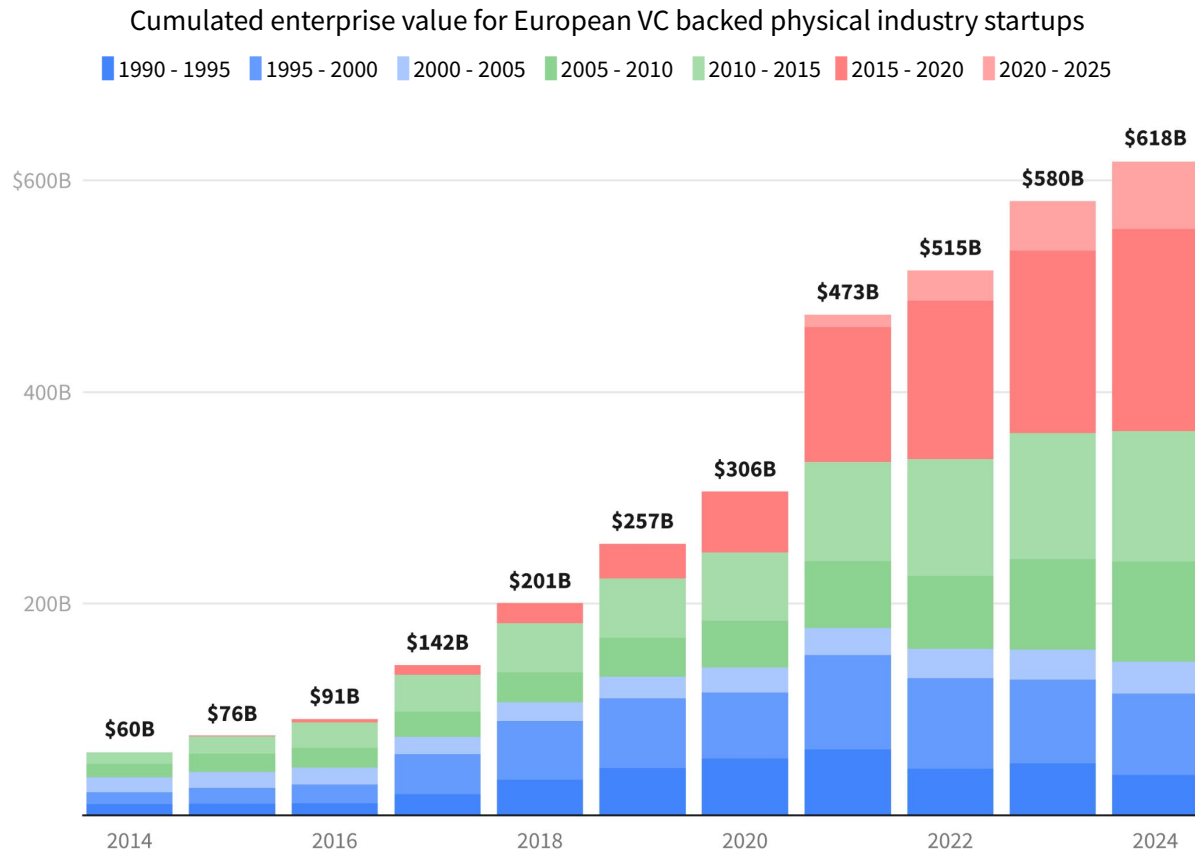
In-space human presence

Combined funding \$ 94M



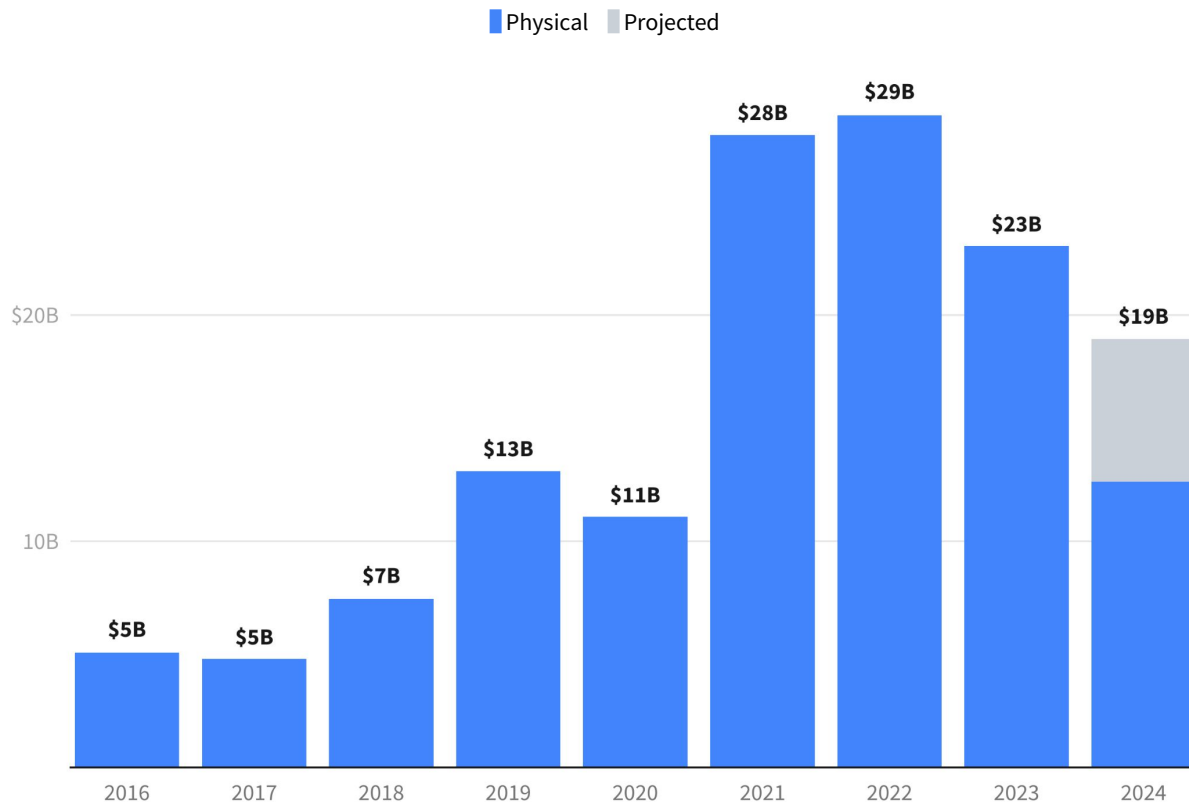
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**European
VC-backed
industrial tech
startups have
passed \$600B
in combined
value.**



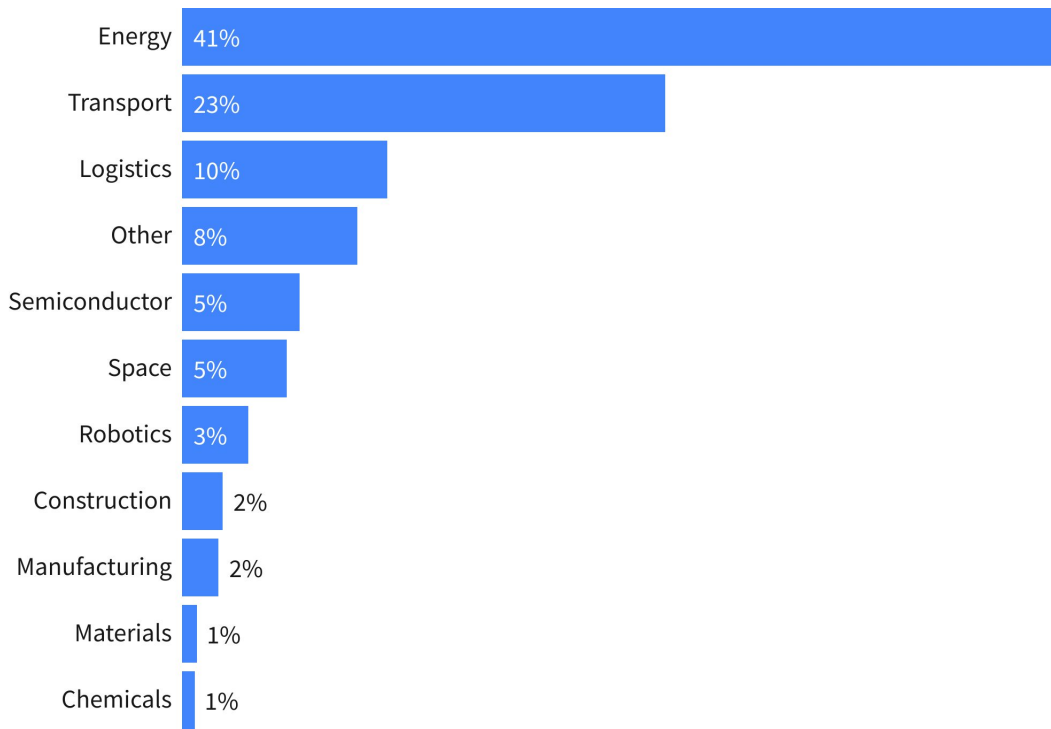
VC funding in industrial tech in Europe is expected to hit \$19B this year.

European VC funding in selected industrial segments



Energy is the leading sector - raised 41% of all industrial tech VC in Europe.

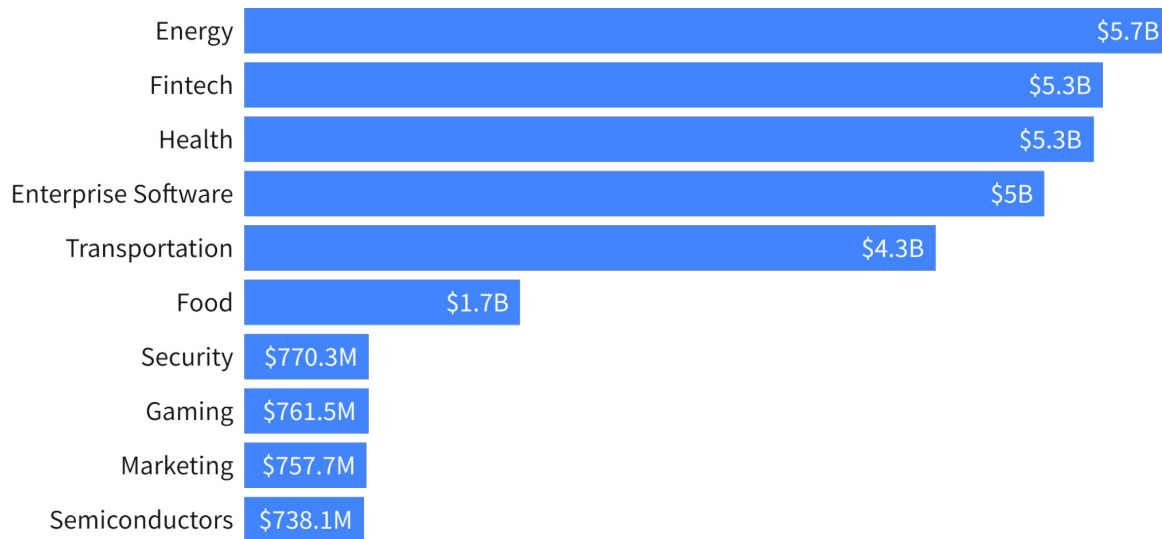
Share of VC funding allocated per physical industries in Europe (2016 - 2024 YTD)



In fact Energy is the most funded sector overall in Europe in 2024.

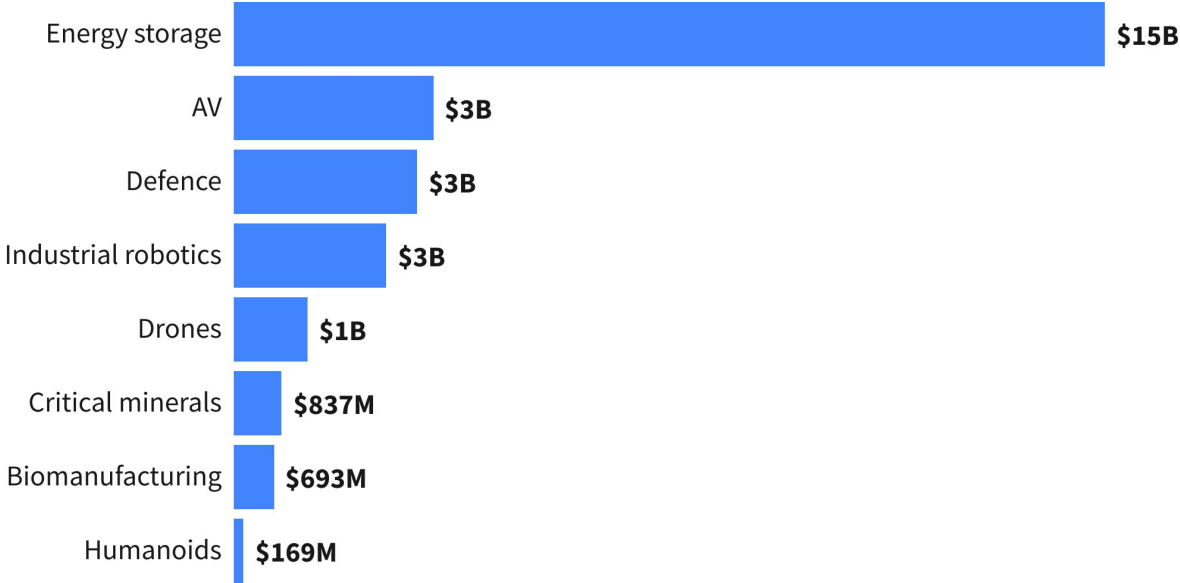
This continues a trend from 2023 when Energy was the top funded industry in Europe every quarter.

Europe's leading industries by VC investment, H1 2024



Energy storage is the most funded physical tech segment in Europe.

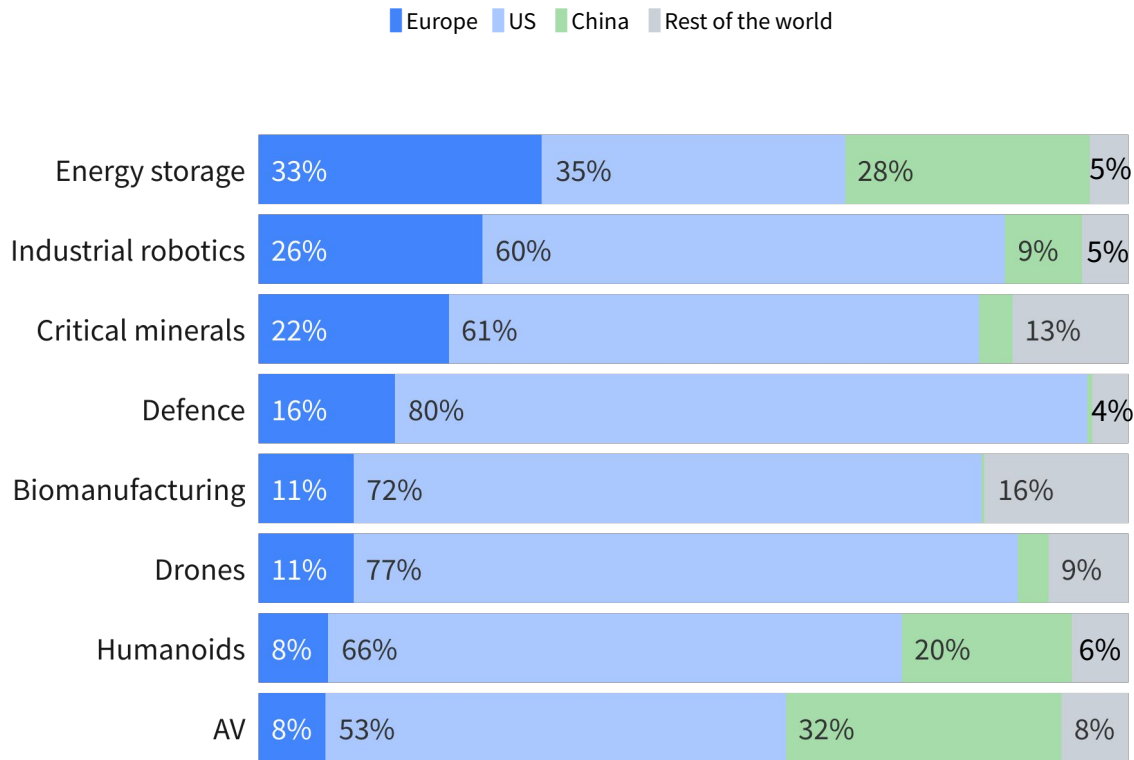
European VC funding in selected physical segments (2016 - 2024)



Europe is performing well in the energy storage, industrial robotics and critical minerals segments in terms of VC funding.

However, it particularly trails behind in Humanoids and Autonomous mobility.

Share of VC funding in key industrial segments (2021-2024 YTD)

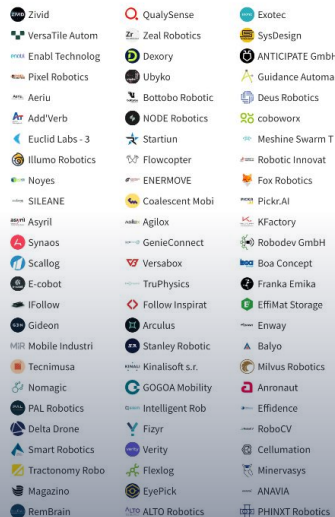


European Industrial Robotics startups

» Explore the landscape

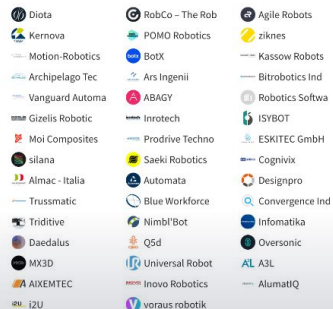
Warehouse automation

Combined funding \$ 802M



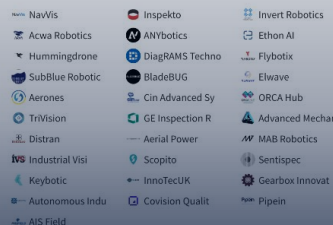
Manufacturing and assembly

Combined funding \$ 472M



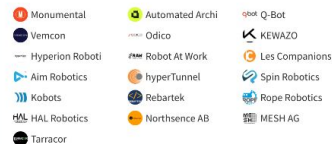
Facility inspection and maintenance

Combined funding \$ 304M



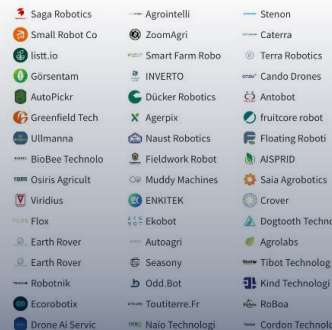
Construction

Combined funding \$ 91M



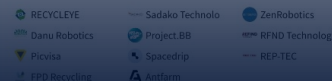
Agriculture

Combined funding \$ 330M



Recycling

Combined funding \$ 49M



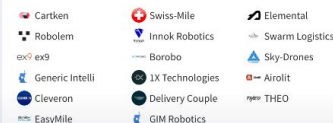
Mining

Combined funding \$ 13M



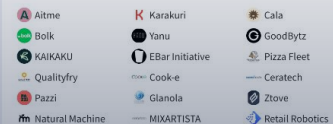
Logistics

Combined funding \$ 258M



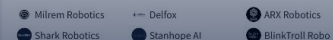
Restaurant tech

Combined funding \$ 86M



Defence

Combined funding \$ 26M



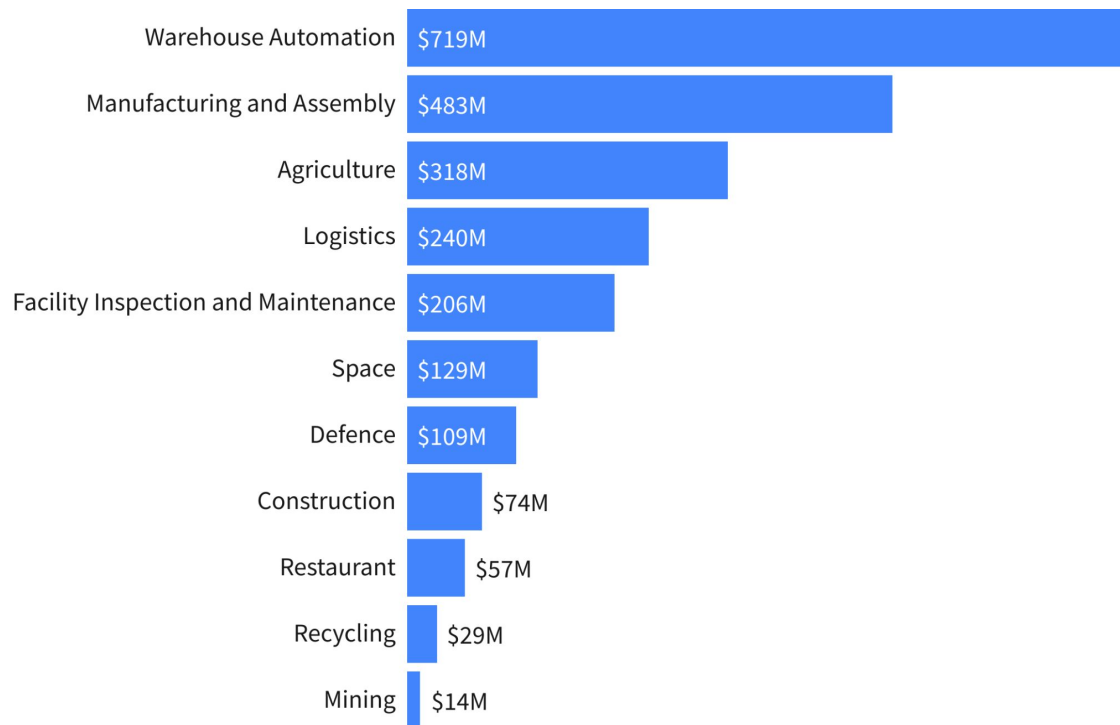
Space

Combined funding \$ 17M



Looking at European industrial robotics, warehouse automation is the most funded segment, followed by manufacturing and assembly robots.

VC funding per European industrial robotics segments (2020-2024 YTD)

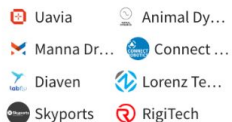


European Industrial Logistics startups

» Explore the landscape

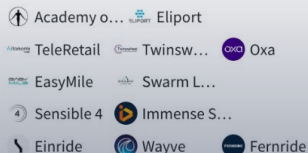
Drones

Combined funding \$ 200M



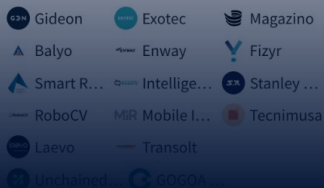
Autonomous Vehicles

Combined funding \$ 1.9B



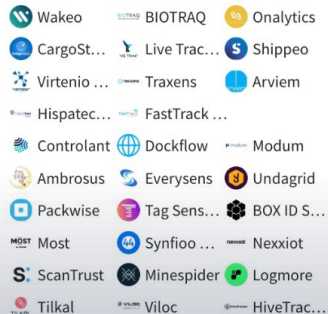
Warehouse Automation

Combined funding \$ 615M



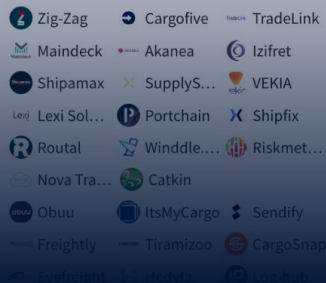
Tracking & Visibility

Combined funding \$ 411M



Supply Chain Management

Combined funding \$ 1.3B



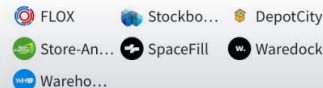
Smart Pallets & Containers

Combined funding \$ 211M



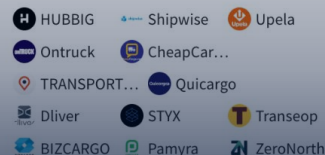
On-demand storage

Combined funding \$ 41M



Shipping Marketplace

Combined funding \$ 76M



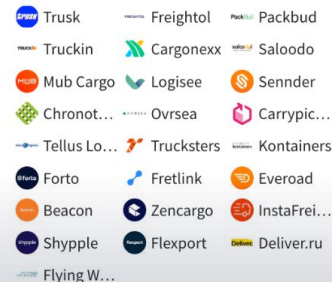
Logistics Procurement

Combined funding \$ 277M



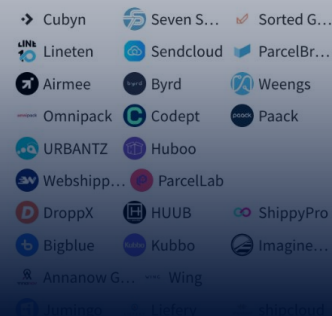
Freight Forwarding

Combined funding \$ 3.7B



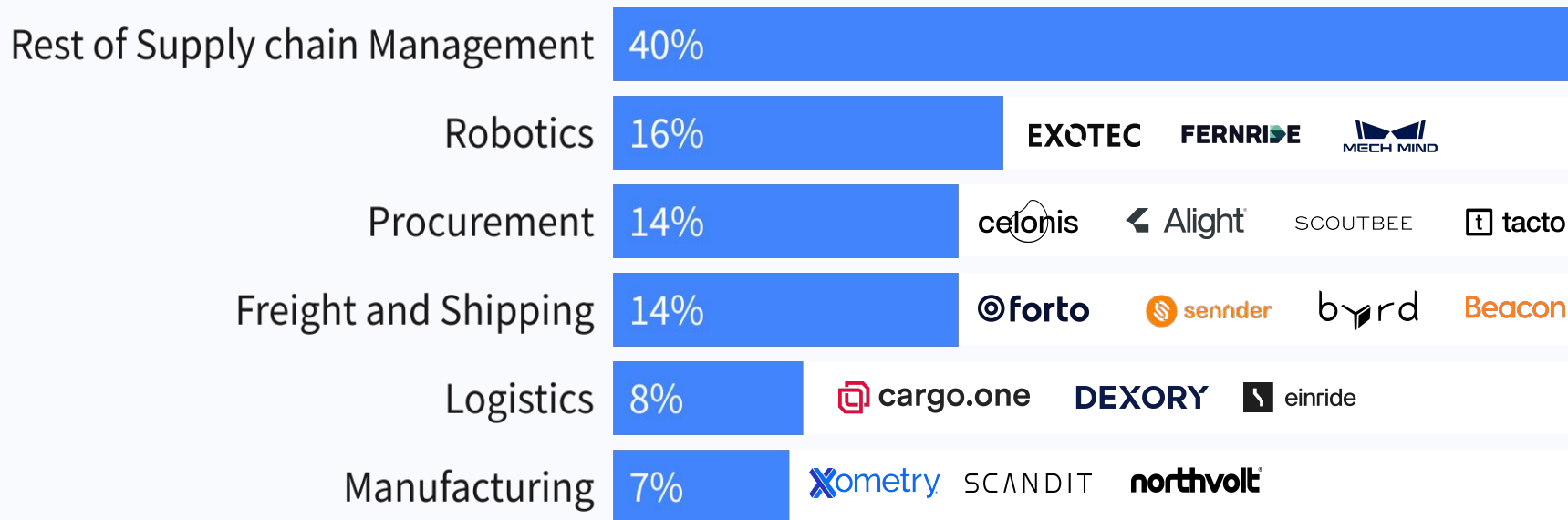
Ecommerce Logistics

Combined funding \$ 1.2B



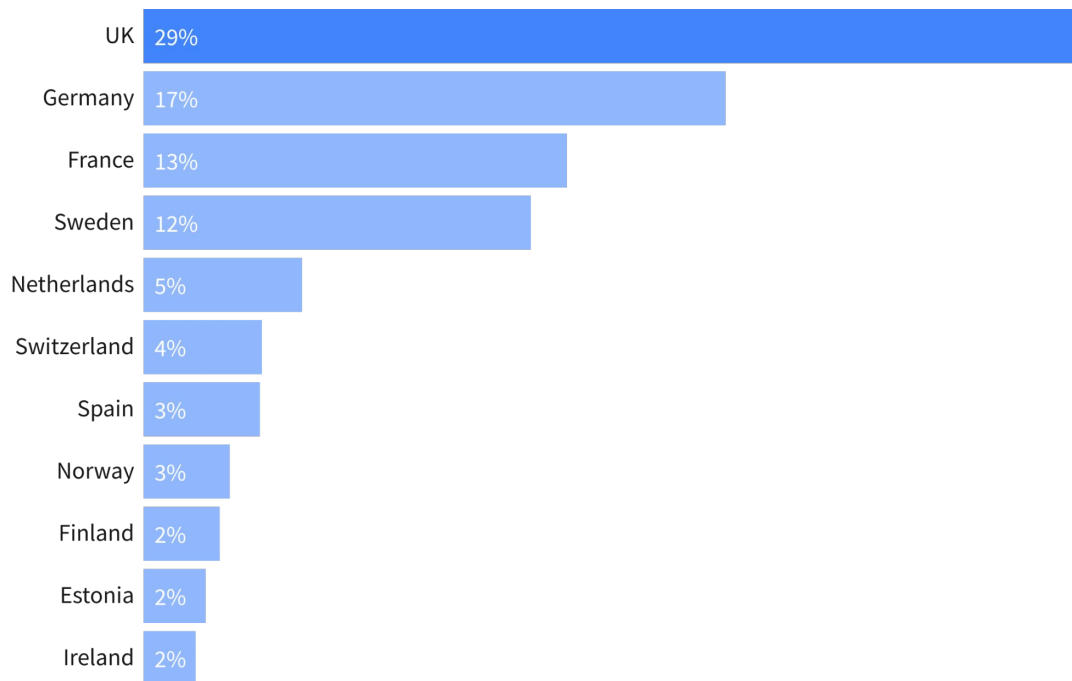
Since 2020, supply chain startups have raised \$14B in VC funding, with a significant portion of which allocated to robotics.

Supply chain management funding by segment (2020-2024 YTD)



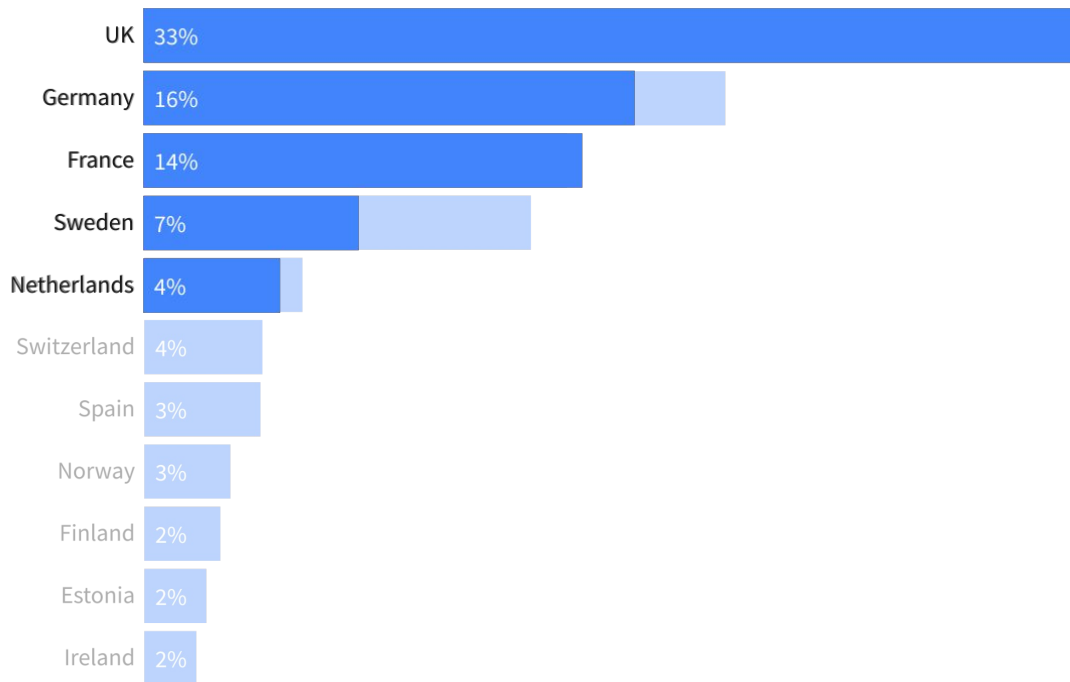
The UK has raised 29% of European physical industry funding.

Share of European VC investment into physical industries (2016 - 2024 YTD)



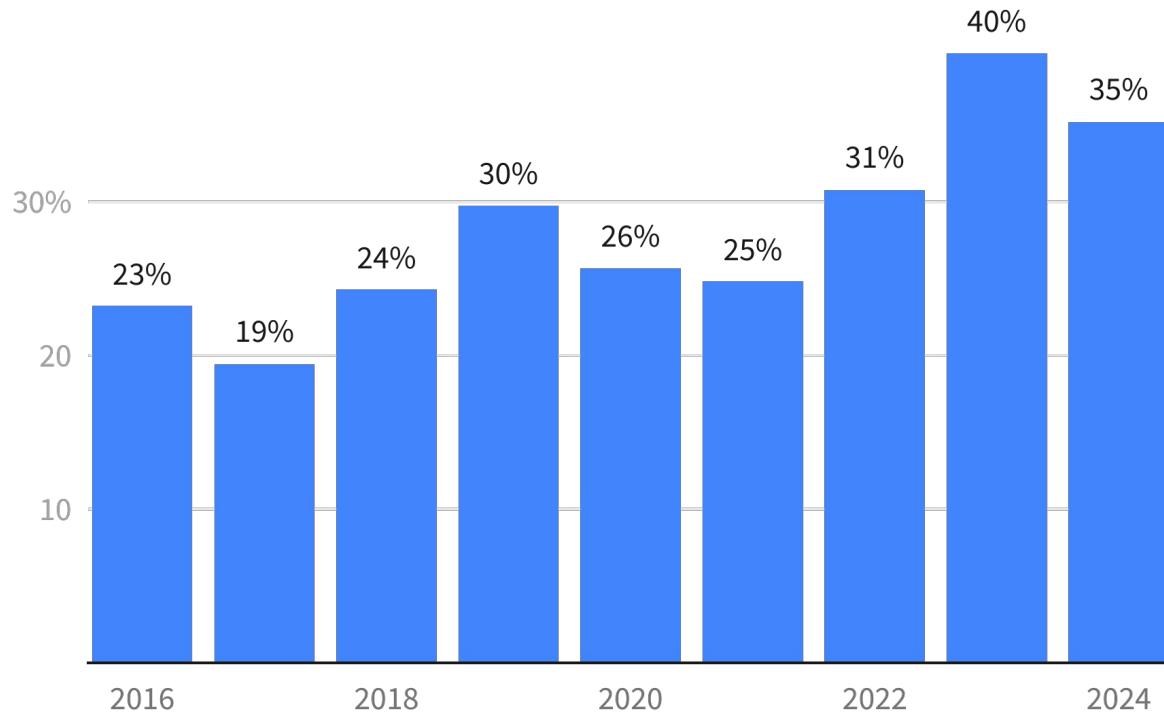
The UK is less dominant in industrial tech than the rest of tech.

Share of European VC investment (2016 - 2024 YTD)



**European tech
is undergoing
a gradual
industrial pivot.**

% of European VC funding going to "physical industries"

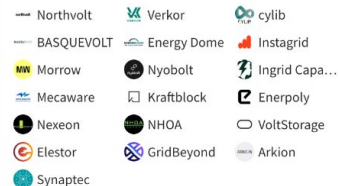


Selected European Physical startups

» Explore the landscape

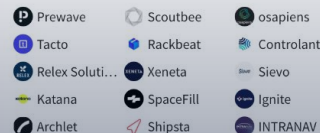
Energy

Combined funding \$ 10.3B



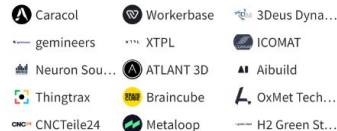
Supply chain management

Combined funding \$ 1.4B



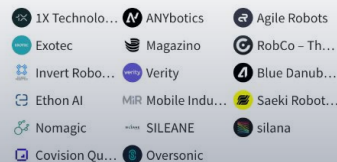
Manufacturing

Combined funding \$ 2.7B



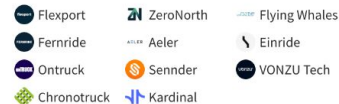
Robotics and automation

Combined funding \$ 1.1B



Logistics

Combined funding \$ 3.3B



Aerospace and defence

Combined funding \$ 2.3B



Critical minerals

Combined funding \$ 151M



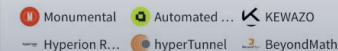
Advanced materials

Combined funding \$ 873M



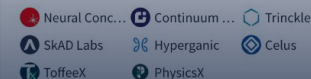
Architecture, engineering and construction (AEC)

Combined funding \$ 59M



Design Software

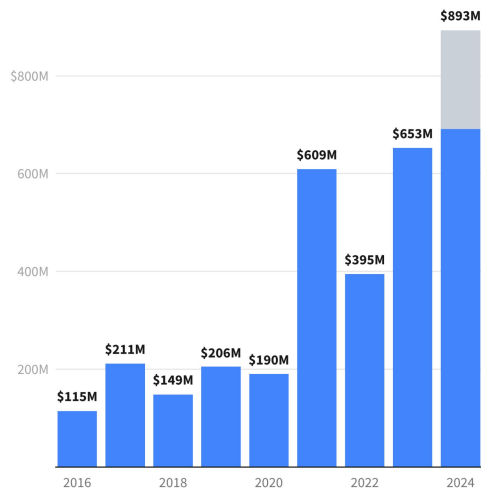
Combined funding \$ 127M



European defence tech

VC investment ('24 projected)

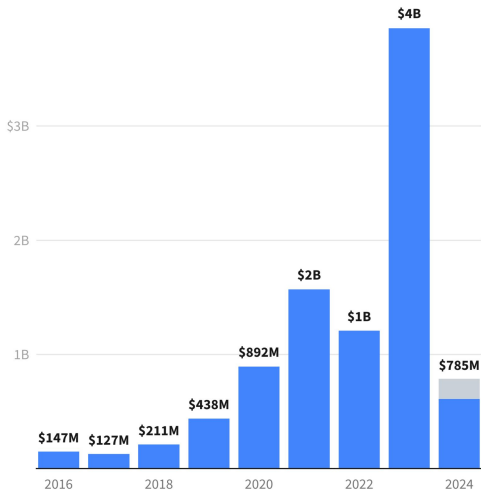
Defence Projected



European grid tech

VC investment ('24 projected)

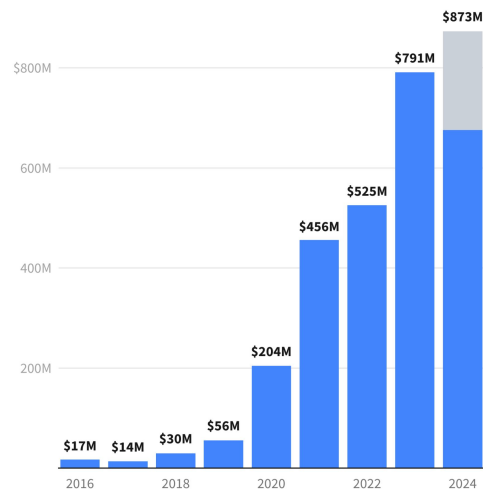
Grid tech Projected



European quantum tech

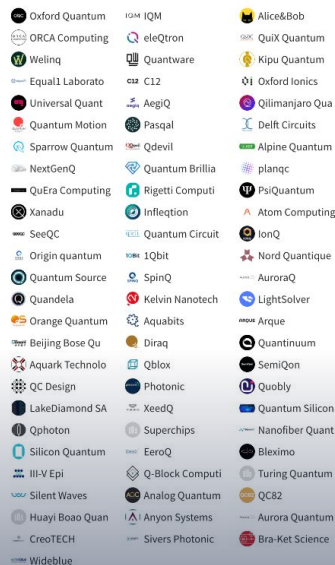
VC investment ('24 projected)

Quantum Projected

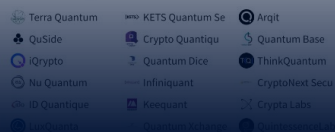
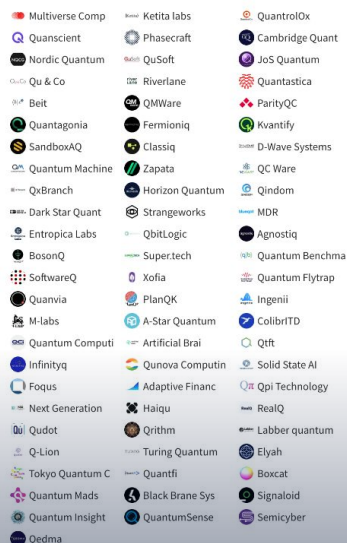


» Explore the landscape

Combined funding \$ 5.1B



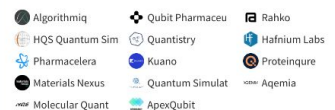
Combined funding \$ 1.6B



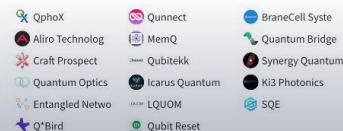
Combined funding \$ 107M



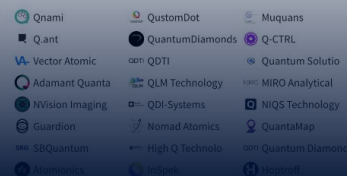
Combined funding \$ 158M



Combined funding \$ 50M



Combined funding \$ 211M



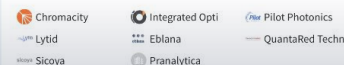
Combined funding \$ 13M



Combined funding \$ 438M



Combined funding \$ 25M



Combined funding \$ 82M



European Defence startups

» Explore the landscape

Command, Control, Communications, Computers, Intelligence, Surveillance and Reconnaissance - C4ISR

Combined funding \$ 275M

- SensuQ
- Revobeam
- QuadSAT
- Disruptive Indu
- Element
- Himera
- Rcam
- Evitado Technol
- Adarga
- AV Optics
- Siren
- Matrix.org
- Silicon MicroGr
- Watch Bird
- RFence
- Ajax Systems
- Inex Microtechn
- SECQAI
- Living Optics
- Labrys
- Scalinx
- KNL Networks
- Focal Point Pos

Weapons/Defence Systems

Combined funding \$ 28M

- Milrem Robotics
- Gwagenn
- Anybody Technol
- Operational Sol
- MyDefence
- MirSense
- Zvook
- Aktyvus Photonix
- SINTERMAT
- Ytsab Defence

UAVs

Combined funding \$ 244M

- Lambda Automata
- Elistair
- KrattWorks
- Dronetag
- STARK
- Unmanned Defens
- SKAI/TECH
- RSI Europe
- Robot Aviation
- Tidav
- HIGHCAT
- Skya
- Monopulse
- Roboneers
- Quantum-Systems
- Alpine Eagle
- Unmanned Life
- TEKEVER
- Baykar Technolo
- Thred Systems
- Aurea Avionics
- WARDrone
- Velos Rotors
- DroneUA
- HIGHCAT
- Sky-Watch
- Browswarm
- ARX Robotics
- Arktis Radiatio
- Zepher Flight L
- Novadem
- Angryeyes
- Greenjets
- Delair
- Origin Robotics
- Avalor AI
- Orqa FPV
- Nordic Unmanned
- Xplor Srl

Naval and Maritime Technologies

Combined funding \$ 34M

- Revco
- LOBSTER Robotic
- Water Linked
- Havguard
- dotOcean
- Elwave
- SEABER
- Maritime Roboti
- Skarv Technolog
- Sotiria Technol
- Hefring Marine

AI x defence

Combined funding \$ 941M

- Helsing
- LatticeFlow
- Hala Systems
- Invisum AI
- Materials Nexus
- Mission Decisio
- TYTAN Technolog
- Ask for the moo
- Archangel Imagi
- Stanhope AI
- Grayscale AI
- Blackshark.ai
- Labelfuse
- Neurobus
- Scaleout System
- Buntar Aerospace
- DefSecintel
- Facuity
- Comand AI
- Preligens
- Aronidite
- Adval
- GScan
- Unbound Automom
- GIGA Venture
- Sky Engine AI

Training and Simulation

Combined funding \$ 15M

- Hologate
- 4C Strategies
- PSS by Logistics 7
- Drill
- Skyral
- Sense Glove
- BlinkTroll Robo
- EODynamics
- Levato AS
- VRAI
- IMPETUS AfearS
- MXR Tactics

Space and Satellite

Combined funding \$ 1.2B

- ALL SPACE
- The Exploration
- CALLABS
- Space Forge
- Tyvak Internati
- Satellite Vu
- Remos
- ICEYE
- Reflex Aerospace
- Spacelis
- Dark
- Fossa Systems
- GomSpace
- Space Apps
- Unseenlabs
- Isar Aerospace
- Astrolight
- Planetek Hellas
- Krono-Safe
- Satcube

Supersonic/ hypersonic planes and propulsion systems

Combined funding \$ 72M

- Destinus
- Aster
- Aerialis
- Magdrive
- Hypersonica

Quantum computing, cryptography and sensing

Combined funding \$ 416M

- Terra Quantum
- KETS Quantum Se
- CryptoNext Secu
- G2-Zero
- Q'Bird
- Qubalt
- Quandela
- QuSide
- Qubitrium
- Ephos
- IQM
- Nu Quantum
- Quantum Dice
- levelQuantum
- AegIQ
- eleQtron

Cybersecurity and critical infrastructure

Combined funding \$ 179M

- Countercraft
- 42Crunch
- Lab 1
- Januus
- DataFlowX
- Modirum
- Goldlock
- EclectIQ
- Arqit
- Runecast
- DeNexus
- Anzen
- ByzGen
- 3IPK
- CyNation
- Osavul

Strategic semiconductors

Combined funding \$ 81M

- Kalray
- Arcon B.V.
- Aquark Technolo
- Black Semicondu
- Swegan
- Nordic Air Defe

Robotics

Combined funding \$ 117M

- ANYbotics
- Vimotek AB
- RobCo - The Rob
- GIM Robotics

Energy (e.g. energy storage)

Combined funding \$ 62M

- LeydenJar Techn
- McGuire Aero Pr
- Ionate
- GaltTec
- Zelestium Techn
- Advanced Materi
- Wpe Research &
- Nordic Batterie
- Ore Energy
- Kitepower
- Icwind
- Molyon

BioDefence

Combined funding \$ 26M

- Ionlace
- delox
- Neuromorphica
- Fabentech
- Aquila Bioscien

Advanced materials and manufacturing

Combined funding \$ 37M

- ICOMAT
- DECPT
- ATLANT 3D

Wearables for Military

Combined funding \$ 5.2M

- Standard Fighti
- Aristela
- Esper Bionics

Advanced Sensing Technology

Combined funding \$ 11M

- Sensrad
- Elfys

Service Providers

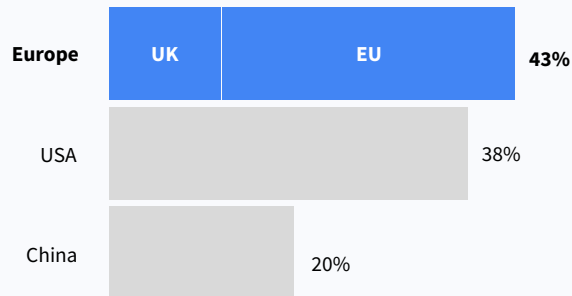
Combined funding \$ 15M

- DigitalPlatform

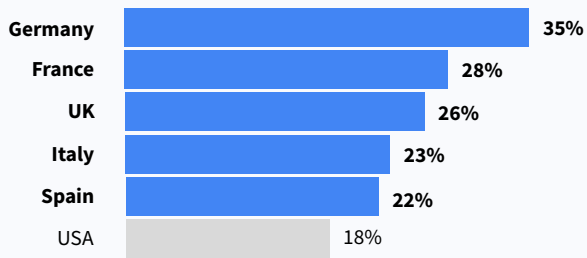
- 1 The rise of Europe
- 2 Entering the new industrial age
- 3 Where Europe stands
- 4 Unlocking European Industrial tech**

Europe has the great technical talent and research leadership required to play a key role in the future of global industrial tech.

High share of highly-cited research publications*



European students are more into science*
(portion of graduates in Science, Technology, Engineering, and Mathematics)



Europe excels in Computer Science ranking (THE 2022)

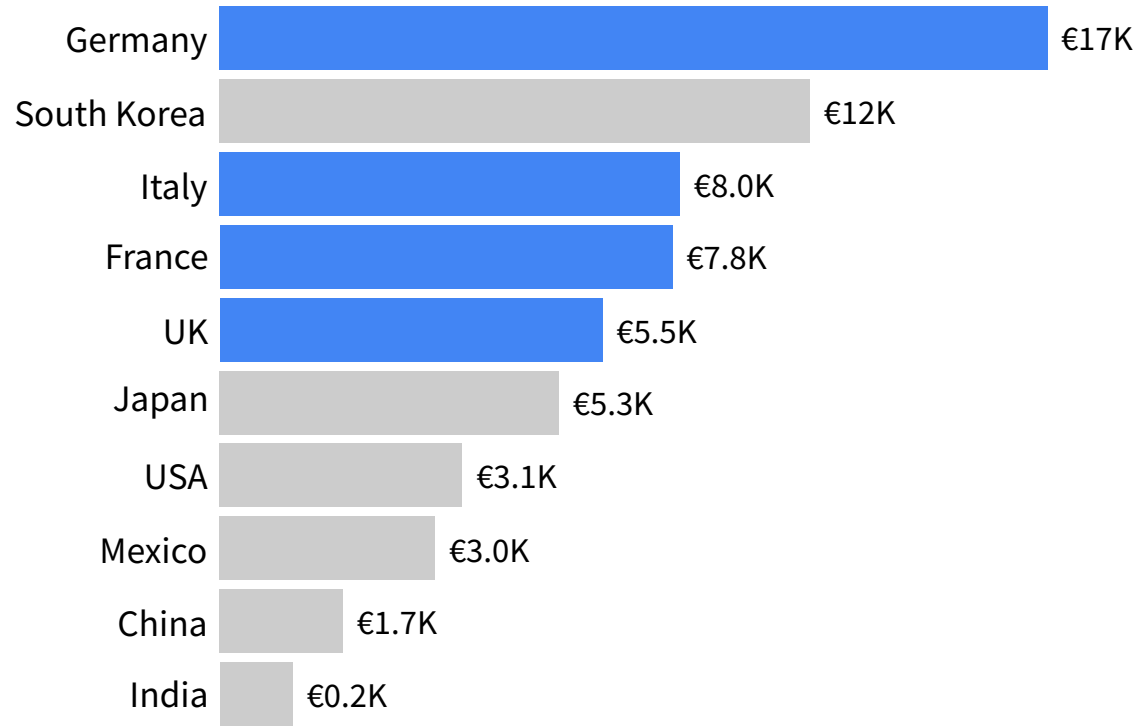
1. Oxford	11. Imperial College London
2. Stanford	12. UCLA
3. MIT	13. Tsinghua (Beijing)
4. ETH Zurich	14. Caltech
4. Cambridge	15. TU Munich
6. CMU	16. Singapore Nanyang
7. Harvard	17. University of Washington
8. Berkeley	18. Cornell
8. National University of Singapore	19. Peking university
10. Princeton	20. École polytechnique fédérale de Lausanne

... and does well also in Engineering ranking (THE 2022)

1. Harvard	11. University of California
2. Stanford	12. Peking university
3. Berkeley	13. Imperial College London
4. MIT	14. Georgia Tech
5. Cambridge	15. Singapore Nanyang
6. Oxford	16. Yale
7. Princeton	17. Tsinghua (Beijing)
8. Caltech	18. Carnegie Mellon University
9. ETH Zurich	19. École polytechnique fédérale de Lausanne
10. National University of Singapore	20. University of Michigan-Ann Arbor

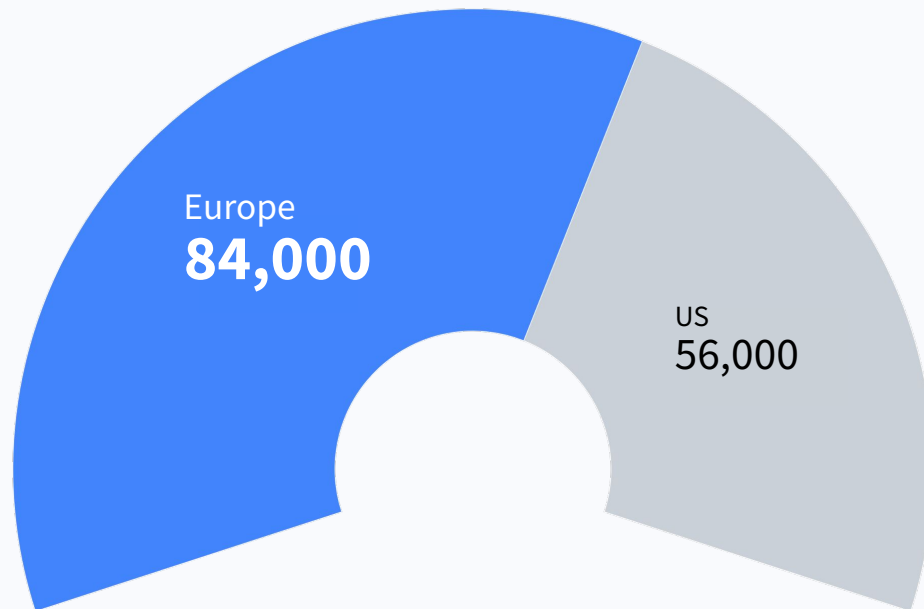
Germany, Italy and France are among the biggest exporters per capita globally (driven by automotive and machinery).

Global rank of manufactured exports per capita
10 biggest manufacturing countries - UN and World Bank data



Europe excels in manufacturing and automation, surpassing the US by number of new robots installed.

New robots installed (2023), IFR



European corporate expenditure dwarfs VC.



50 million
employees



€13 trillion turnover
(of which $\pm 25\%$ Value Added* to
European economy as GDP)

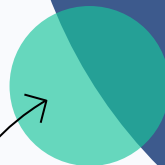


**Spending 2.5% to 3% on
Information Technology**

€ 300–400 billion per year

Another 3 to 4% investment into Industry 4.0 solutions
= € 400-500 billion per year

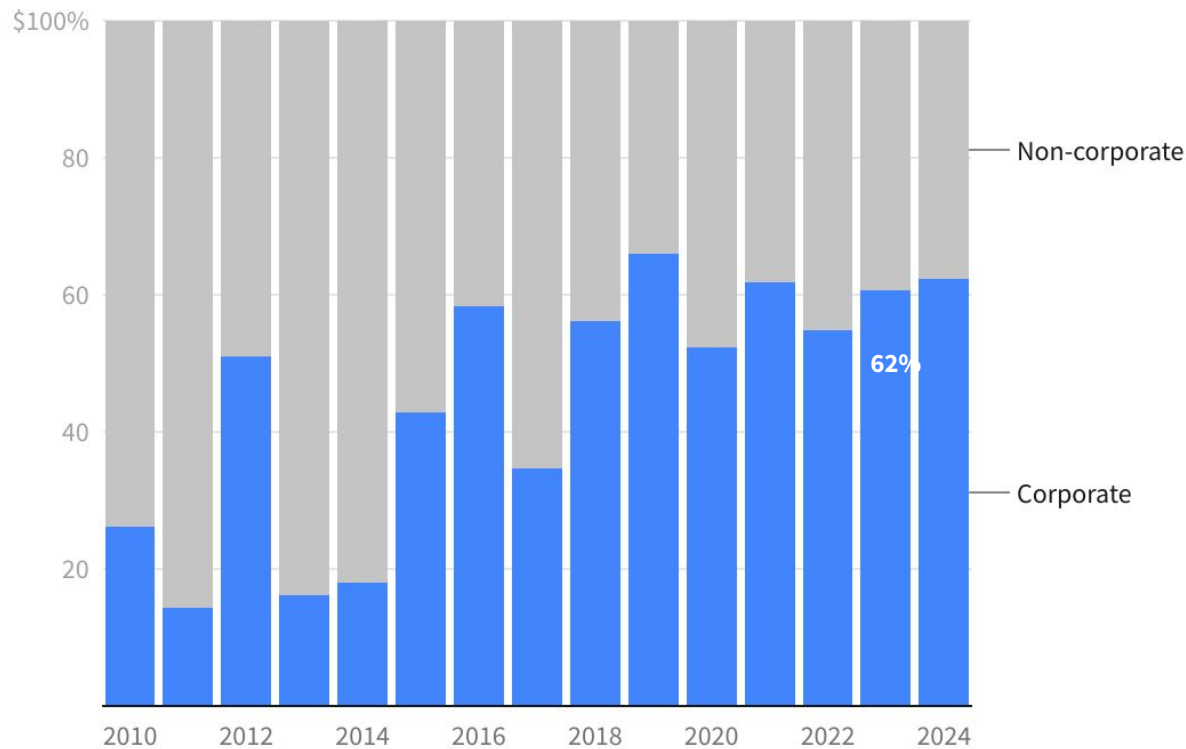
**€700–900 billion
annual spending**
on information technology and
industry 4.0 capex



**€20
billion**
VC investment

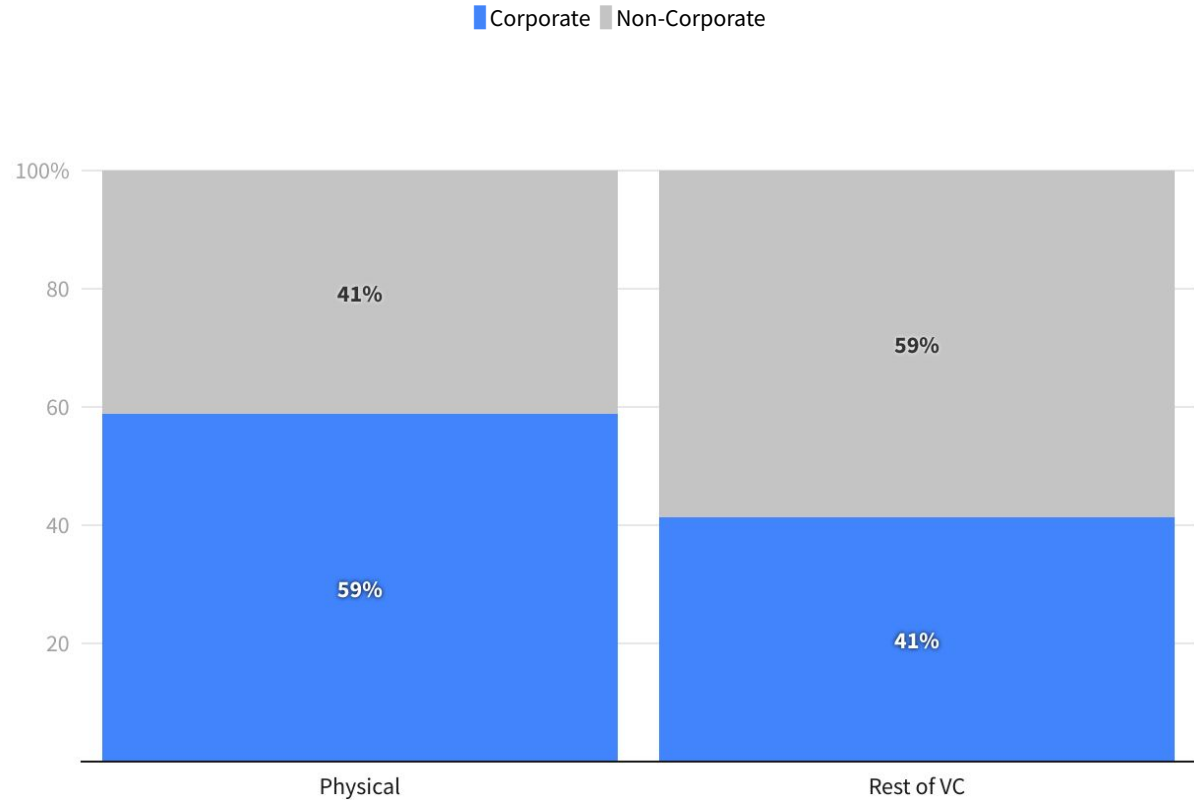
**Corporates
involvement in
European
industrial tech
VC is on the rise.**

Corporate funding in selected industrial segments, Europe



Corporates are taking much more venture interest in Industrial tech.

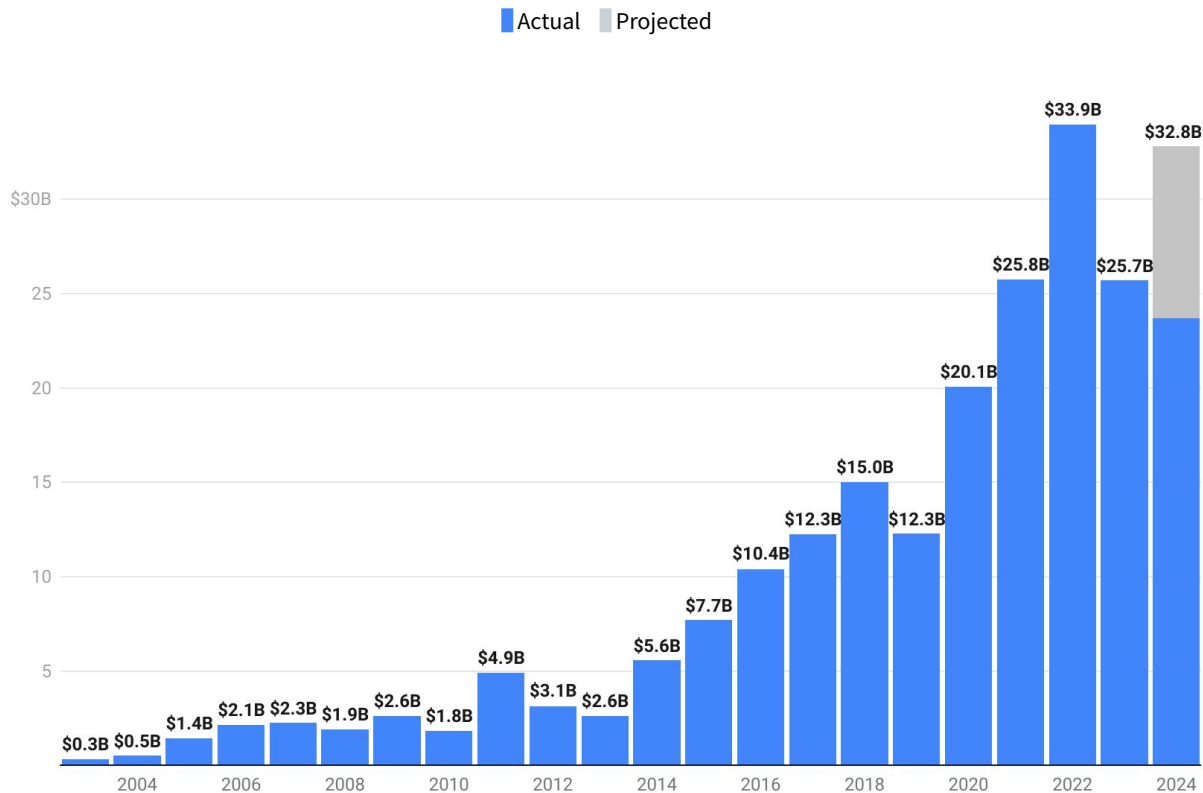
Share corporate funding in selected industrial segments vs Rest of VC



**Record
amounts of
dry powder
reported.**

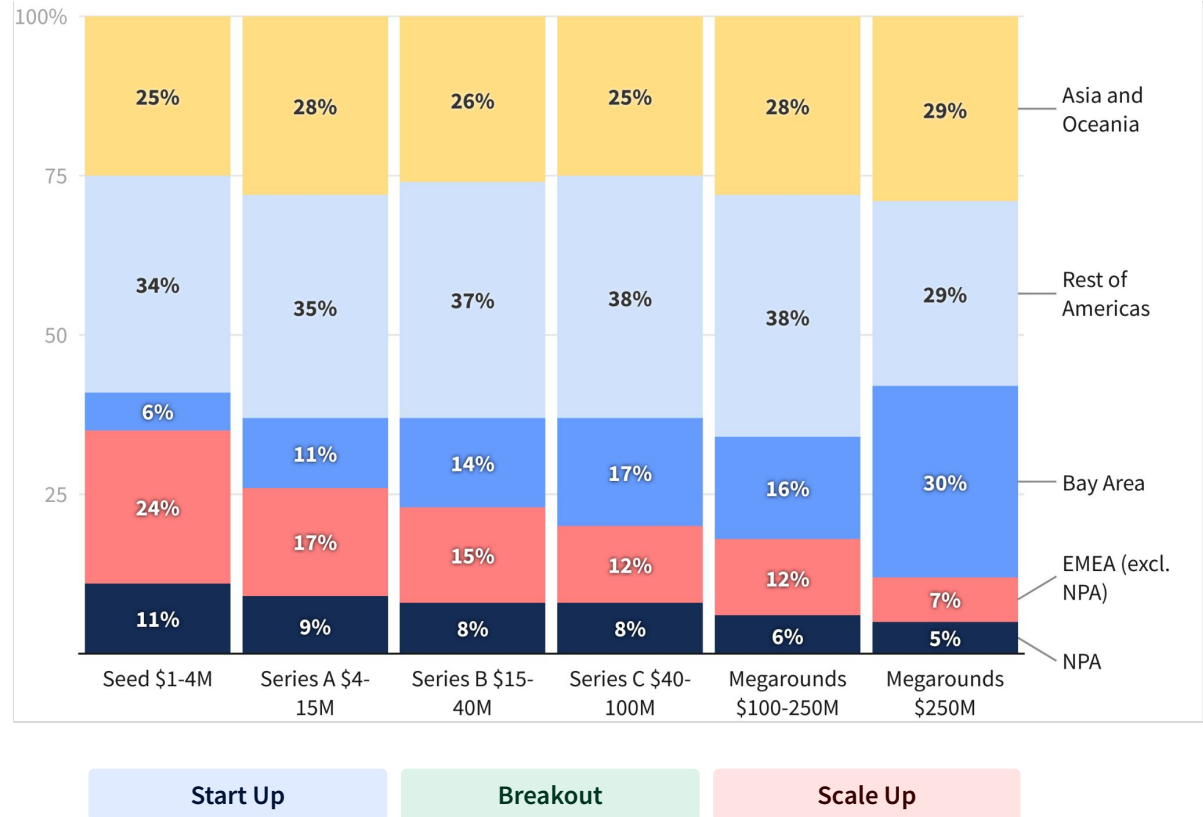
**But the amount
of European
funds is still
lags the US in
terms of
ecosystem size.**

European VC funds raised by investor



Venture capital by destination and by stage (2020-2023)

Despite strength at Seed & Series A, EMEA is very underinvested at later stages relative to other geographies.



A few words on our methodology.

What is a startup?

Companies designed to grow fast. Generally, such companies are VC-investable businesses. Sometimes they can become very big (e.g. \$1B+ valuation). When startups are successful, they develop into scaleups (>50 people), grownups (>500 people) and result in big companies. Only companies founded since 1990 are included in this report.

What is a startup?

What is a Unicorn?

Unicorns are (former) startups that reached \$1B valuation or exit at one point in time.

What is a Unicorn?

Physical industries and industrial tech

Physical industries includes both hardware and/or software focused on physical sectors. So it includes both batteries for energy storage, but also software for grid management for instance.

Industrial Tech is in Dealroom implemented more as solutions for industrial sectors that are more transversal such as industrial procurement, industrial logistics, etc. It does not include software to manage grids or battery energy storage.

Geographic methodology

Startups are assigned to the location of their current HQ. In case a startup moves its HQ location the change is applied in Dealroom, while the first HQ is regarded as founding location. The location of most of the employees or the founder nationality are not taken into account.

Underlying data

Dealroom's proprietary database and software aggregate data from multiple sources: harvesting public information, user-submitted data verified by Dealroom, data engineering. Data is verified and curated with an extensive manual process. The data on which this report builds is available via app.dealroom.co. For more info please visit support@dealroom.co.

Venture capital definition

Investment are referred to by their round labels such as Seed, Series A, B, C, ... late stage, and growth equity.

VC investments excludes debt or other non-equity funding, lending capital, grants and ICOs.

Buyouts, M&A, secondary rounds, and IPOs are treated as exits: excluded from funding data, but included in exit data.



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ENTROPY
INDUSTRIAL
CAPITAL